



Macintosh 128K Teardown

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8 Pack, a pro overclocker from UK broke 10 different records in a single session.
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Telecom set to transform in 2014

Many changes are on the horizon, but will it all pan out the way it should?

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The year 2014 is going to be a very crucial year for the telecom space. This year will see the culmination of many goals important to players in the sector – this includes spectrum allocation, laying out of policies on license terms & conditions, M&A, security, green telecom targets and roadmap for future technologies. Operators will now fully focus on users.

This focus was evidently missing in the recent past. Higher data tariff rates, slow 3G penetration, lack of unique plans, back-and-forth between the government and operators on a range of issues had brought the industry to a standstill. However, 2014 will be a game changer. Not just for the industry, but for you, the user also.

4G to go mainstream?

3G growth has been slower than expected. This is mainly due to the higher tariff rates which, industry sources predict, won't ease up anytime soon in the near



The telecom sector has high hopes for 4G

future. Cheaper 3G data plans by a few operators didn't help thrust 3G into the mainstream either. Many Internet users are still on 2G despite the slower network due to even lower tariff rates.

4G, however, is expected to provide the much-needed boost to this segment. Bharti Airtel has already launched its 4G

services in select cities, while operators such as Aircel have begun preparations for the 4G network. Airtel will soon be expanding its 4G network in major circles such as Delhi, Mumbai, Haryana and Kerala.

Reliance Jio Infocomm is the star in the segment, holding pan-India spectrum for 4G services. The company claims that its 4G wireless broadband services will be about 10-12 times faster than the current 3G networks.

Rather than speed, however, pricing will play a key role in the growth of the 4G network; affordable 4G plans and 4G-based products will herald its imminent fame. With the launch of 4G smartphones, especially the budget ones, we can expect decent growth for 4G this year.

"Mobile technologies are improving and soon we will see 4G mobile networks increasingly being able to deliver rich internet access and mobile data traffic. 4G services are expected to be available in certain parts of country for sure, especially in the metros, but we don't see it going mainstream as 2G or 3G services are at present," says Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI), Director General, Rajan S Mathews.

Co-existence of 2G, 3G and... CDMA?

Let's say 4G services go on to dominate the telecom industry, what then? Will it spell the end of the older networks viz 3G, 2G and CDMA? Not really. Considering that a large number of customers are still on these networks, operators are unlikely to ignore them.

"2G services are still very much the core of telecom services being provided to Indian customers. Most of the internet and VAS services are currently accessed



Telecom sector set to make a turnaround in 2014

through 2G services only. We believe 2G services will continue to be the key component for serving the majority of the customer base in the country this year," adds Rajan S Mathews.

Speaking about the possibilities of 3G tariff dropping, he further says, "Lowering of 3G services prices will depend upon availability and spectrum pricing and policy framework. So if all goes well, we will definitely see lower 3G pricing and increase in customer uptake of the same."

CDMA-exclusive operator, Sistema Shyam TeleServices Ltd (SSTL), also known as MTS India, last year launched next-generation EV-DO Rev. B Phase II technology, which claims to deliver